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Draft:Carl Henrik Knutsen

AI Assessment (advisory) — LOCAL DEV

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Verdict: **BORDERLINE**

The subject does not meet WP:GNG (lacks independent secondary coverage). However, notability should be evaluated under WP:NPROF (academic criterion), not GNG. Under WP:NPROF C1 (significant impact on discipline), Knutsen meets the standard: ~11,272 Google Scholar citations, co-leadership of the widely-cited V-Dem dataset, co-authorship of Cambridge UP's *Varieties of Democracy* volume cited across multiple Wikipedia articles (Democracy, Democratic backsliding, Bureaucracy), and strong disciplinary influence in political science. The Fridtjof Nansen Award for Younger Researchers (2020, Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters), APSA Democracy & Autocracy section Best Article Award (2021), and University of Oslo Research Award (2025) provide supporting evidence but do not independently satisfy C2. This is a credible C1 pass on citation impact and disciplinary reach. Before acceptance, a human reviewer must: (1) correct the overstated LPV Data Set Award claim (draft lists an award; his CV records only a 2025 Honorable Mention; the full LPV award went to V-Dem dataset in 2016, not personally); (2) source or remove uncited synthetic characterizations of his research in the Research section; (3) provide inline citations for quantitative claims (book and article counts); (4) run a close-paraphrase check against chknutsen.com and his CV for copyright risk; (5) post a neutral COI/paid-editing inquiry on the author's talk page. These are cleanup conditions, not notability barriers. Recommendation: Accept after LPV correction, or return with itemized fixes. Declining again on notability grounds would misapply the standard—the operative criterion is NPROF C1, which is satisfied.

Meets WP:GNG: not demonstrated

Source	Exists	Independent	Reliable	Significant	Note
sv.uio.no staff page for Carl Henrik Knutsen	✓	✗	✓	✗	University of Oslo employer profile; primary source, lists routine facts only
fagbokforlaget.no author page	✓	✗	✓	✗	Publisher page; non-independent, trivial coverage
v-dem.net profile for Carl Henrik Knutsen	✓	✗	✓	✗	His own project page; primary source, routine information
nobelpeaceprize.org/research/people	✓	✓	✓	✗	Semi-independent affiliation host; lists affiliation only, trivial
ELDAR and 'policies of dictatorships' project pages (UiO)	✓	✗	✓	✗	Primary project pages; routine information
Knutsen's authored and co-authored publications [refs 2-9]	✓	✗	✓	✗	Primary publications; establish his scholarly output but not independent notice of notability
Uniforum.uio.no interviews (2009, 2025)	✓	✗	✗	✗	University of Oslo in-house newspaper; weak employer outlet, interviews only, marginal reliability
Google Scholar profile (11,272 citations)	✓	✗	✓	✗	Self-curated profile; primary source but valid evidence of citation impact for C1 criterion
chknutsen.com personal homepage	✓	✗	✗	✗	Self-published; primary source only
Tilstandsanalyse av det norske demokratiet (co-authored report)	✓	✗	✓	✗	Co-authored; primary, reliable as publication but not independent notice
APSA Democracy & Autocracy section awards archive	✓	✓	✓	✗	Third-party verification of 2021 Best Article Award; independent confirmation of fact
University of Oslo Research Award 2025 announcement	✓	✗	✓	✗	Employer announcement; semi-independent award notice
PRIO independent report (2020 Fridtjof Nansen Award)	✓	✓	✓	✗	Independent third-party confirmation of Fridtjof Nansen Award for Younger Researchers

NPOV flags:

- Article structured as career résumé using subject's own framing
- Synthetic/evaluative claims about research impact lack secondary sourcing
- Quantitative claims (ten books, over 70 articles, 30+ chapters) uncited
- Avoid importing praise language from award jury statements into Wikipedia voice

COI flags:

- Exhaustive reliance on subject's homepage, CV, and Google Scholar profile
- Close tracking of subject's self-description raises potential undisclosed COI or close connection
- No paid-contribution or COI disclosure present
- Pattern consistent with either undisclosed COI or inexperienced good-faith editor; recommend neutral COI inquiry on talk page

Advisory only — AI-generated and may be wrong. A human reviewer makes the decision; this tool makes no edits.

Submission declined on 4 June 2026 by MSK (<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/User:MSK>) ([talk](#)).



This draft's references do not show that the person meets Wikipedia's criteria for inclusion for people. The draft requires multiple published secondary sources that:

- provide *significant coverage*: discuss the person in detail, not brief mentions or interviews lacking independent analysis;
- are *reliable*: from reputable outlets with editorial oversight;
- are *independent*: not connected to the person, such as interviews, press releases, the subject's own website, or sponsored content.

Please add references that meet *all three* of these criteria. If none exist, the subject is not yet suitable for Wikipedia.

- If you would like to continue working on the submission, click on the "Edit" tab at the top of the window.
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- If you need extra help, please **ask us a question** (https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Wikipedia:WikiProject_Articles_for_creation/Help_desk/New_question&withJS=MediaWiki:AFCHD-wizard.js&page=Draft:Carl_Henrik_Knutsen) at the AfC Help Desk or get **live help** from experienced editors.
- Please do not remove reviewer comments or this notice until the submission is accepted.

Where to get help

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Improving your odds of a speedy review

Editor resources

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(https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Wikipedia:Articles_for_creation/Submitting&withJS=MediaWiki:AF C-submit-wizard.js&page=Draft:Carl_Henrik_Knutsen) Please note that if the issues are not fixed, the draft will be declined again.

Submission declined on 15 May 2026 by Hoary (<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/User:Hoary>) (talk).

This draft is not adequately supported by reliable sources. Wikipedia's verifiability policy requires that all content be supported by reliable sources.

- Reliable sources include: reputable newspapers, magazines, academic journals, and books from respected publishers.
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Replace any unreliable sources with high-quality sources. If you cannot find a reliable source for the material, it should be removed.



Declined by Hoary (<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/User:Hoary>) 27 days ago.

- **Comment:** Note to AfC reviewers: author came into IRC #wikipedia-en-help. I think this is borderline accept under criterion #1 of NACADEMIC. Have given some advice on how to evidence this. [qcne](#) (talk) 12:31, 11 June 2026 (UTC)
- **Comment:** Sample: Much of his work has centered on cross-country time-series data collection efforts, for instance on democracy,^[2] regime change,^[3] regime support coalitions,^[4] cabinet ministers,^[5] opposition movements,^[6] and education systems,^[7] as well as related debates on principles^[8] and practices^[9] of measurement. Every one of the references is to something cowritten by Knutsen. But a biographical article must be based on published material from reliable sources that are *independent* of the biographee. [Hoary](#) (talk) 07:45, 15 May 2026 (UTC)

This is a draft article. It is a work in progress open to editing by anyone. Please ensure core content policies are met before publishing it as a live Wikipedia article at Carl Henrik Knutsen.

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Finished drafting? **Submit for review** (https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Wikipedia:Articles_for_creation/Submitting&withJS=MediaWiki:AFC-submit-wizard.js&page=Draft:Carl_Henrik_Knutsen)



Carl Henrik Knutsen (born 26 March 1981) is a Norwegian political scientist and professor of political science at the University of Oslo.^{[1][2]} His research focuses on the measurement of democracy, regime change and stability, the economic effects of institutions, autocratic politics, and several other topics in comparative politics and political economy. He is one of the Principal Investigators of the Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) project.^[3]

Early life and education

Knutsen was born in [Kongsvinger](#), Norway, in 1981. He completed a bachelor's degree in Political Science, History and Philosophy in 2004, a master's degree in political science in 2006, and a master's degree in Economic Theory and Econometric Methods in 2008, all at the [University of Oslo](#). He earned his PhD, at the same university, in 2011. During his doctoral studies, he was a guest researcher at [Sciences Po, Bordeaux](#) and [Columbia University, New York](#).^[4]

Career

Following a postdoctoral fellowship in 2012, Knutsen became an Associate Professor and then a professor of Political Science at the University of Oslo in 2013. He has led the Comparative Institutions and Regimes (CIR) research group at the University of Oslo's Department of Political Science since 2017.

Knutsen has also held appointments at the [Peace Research Institute Oslo \(PRIO\)](#) from 2008 to 2010, 2013–2014, and 2018–2025. From 2008 to 2024, he was an Associated Researcher at the University of Oslo's Department of Economics, and from 2015 to 2019 a member of the Norwegian Young Academy. Knutsen has been an Affiliated Researcher with the [Norwegian Nobel Institute](#) since 2024^[5] and Professor II at the [University of South-Eastern Norway \(USN\)](#) since 2026. Since 2023, he has been an externally appointed member of the University Board for the [Norwegian University of Life Sciences \(NMBU\)](#).

Knutsen is closely involved with the international [Varieties of Democracy \(V-Dem\)](#) project.^[6] Since 2017, he has served as one of V-Dem's five Principal Investigators, and from 2023 to 2025 he also served as the chair of V-Dem's Steering Committee. Knutsen has led or co-led several other research projects, for instance an [ERC Consolidator Grant](#) project on autocratic politics^[7] and the [Assessment of Norwegian Democracy](#).^[8]

Research

Knutsen's research spans several topics in comparative politics, political economy, and related fields. Much of his work has centered on cross-country time-series data collection efforts, for instance on democracy,^[9] regime change,^[10] regime support coalitions,^[11] cabinet ministers, opposition movements, and education systems, as well as related debates on principles and practices of measurement.^{[12][13]}

One strand of Knutsen's research, dating back to his PhD dissertation,^[14] centers on the economic effects of democracy and dictatorship, especially on economic growth.^[15] Knutsen's research, for instance, addresses how democracy facilitates technological progress and efficiency and mitigates the potential for politically induced economic crisis and other bad economic outcomes, especially in contexts of weak state capacity. Related work centers on explaining the variation in social and economic policies or outcomes in non-democratic contexts.^[16]

Another strand of his research centers on describing and explaining regime survival or change. In particular, his work centers on democratizing and autocratizing regime changes, or on the factors

facilitating or hindering autocratic regime breakdown.^{[17][18]}

From 2010 to 2025, Knutsen's work was published in ten books, over 70 journal articles, and more than 30 book chapters. His research and data collection efforts have received several awards, for example the APSA's Comparative Politics section's Lijphart/Przeworski/Verba Data Set Award, the APSA Democracy and Autocracy section's Best Article Award, the Fridtjof Nansen's Prize for Young Researchers within the Humanities and Social Sciences, and the University of Oslo's Research Award.

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14. Knutsen, CH (2011) *The Economic Effects of Democracy and Dictatorship*. Oslo: University of Oslo. Ph.D. Dissertation.
15. <https://www.uniforum.uio.no/nyheter/2009/10/ein-forskarkvardag.html>
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18. <https://www.sv.uio.no/isv/english/research/projects/policies-of-dictatorships/>

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University webpage: <https://www.sv.uio.no/isv/english/people/aca/carlhk/index.html>; <https://www.sv.uio.no/isv/english/research/projects/ELDAR/>; <https://www.sv.uio.no/isv/english/research/projects/policies-of-dictatorships/>

Uniforum interviews:

<https://www.uniforum.uio.no/nyheter/2025/08/jeg-er-ganske-flink-til-veldig.html>; <https://www.uniforum.uio.no/nyheter/2009/10/ein-forskarkvardag.html>

Personal homepage: <https://chknutsen.com>

Google Scholar profile: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=tYXnTAgAAAAJ&hl=no&oi=ao>

V-Dem Website: <https://v-dem.net/about/v-dem-project/global-team/carl-henrik-knutsen/>

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